

Nicolas Bau

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EDUCATION

University of Geneva

Switzerland

Ph.D. Candidate in Political Science

2022 –

Dissertation: “*The Political Economy of National Development Finance Institutions*”

Advisor: *Simone Dietrich*

Princeton University

USA

Visiting Student Research Collaborator, Department of Politics

2025 – 2026

Sponsor: *Layna Mosley*

Sciences Po Paris

France

M.A. in Political Science

2020 – 2022

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

5. Guaranteeing the Global Gateway: National DFIs and the Transformation of EU Development Finance (with Simone Dietrich).
Journal of European Integration, Forthcoming for a Special Issue on the Global Gateway.
4. Populism and the Politics of Aid Classification: Evidence from the OECD Development Assistance Committee (with Simone Dietrich, Katharina Fleiner, and Alice Iannantuoni).
International Studies Quarterly, Forthcoming.
3. The Institutional Politics of Development Finance: ODA's Role in Shaping Subnational DFI Investments (with Simone Dietrich, Jing Qian, and Duy Trinh).
Review of International Organizations, 2026.
2. Examining New Donors in the OECD's Development Assistance Committee (with Simone Dietrich, Katharina Fleiner, and Alice Iannantuoni).
Journal of International Development, 2025.
1. Compte-rendu de “Chiapello, E., et al. (2023). Financializations of Development. Global Games and Local Experiments. Routledge”.
Gouvernement et action publique, 2025.

WORKING PAPERS

3. Between Markets and Statecraft: Shareholder Capital and Bilateral Development Finance Institutions' Investment.
To be presented at *APSA 2026*, *WIFI 2026*.
2. What Geopolitical Returns Does Official Development Assistance Bring?. With Simone Dietrich.
Kiel Working Paper (2025). *Global Nation Briefing* (2026).
Covered in *Der Spiegel*.
1. Measuring Debt Transparency in Developing Countries: An IRT Approach. With Zoe Ge, Layna Mosley, and B. Peter Rosendorff.
PSFL Policy Brief 25-3 (2025).

WORKS IN PROGRESS

5. Donor Identity and Citizen Evaluation of Aid Projects. With Maria Nagawa.
4. Private Capital Mobilization in Infrastructure Development. With Simone Dietrich, Jihye Park, and Jing Qian.
3. The U.S. Development Finance Corporation and Sponsor Firm Politics in Frontier Investment. With Simone Dietrich and Jihye Park
To be presented *APSA 2026*.
2. Small Donors and the World Bank's IFC: Explaining Co-Financing in Development. With Tetsekela Anyiam-Osigwe.
1. Compete or Coordinate? The Politics of Investment Pooling in Development Finance.

POLICY WRITINGS

3. Assessing the Additionality of Development Finance Institutions: frameworks, challenges, guidance (with Fatoumata Ngom and Valérie Gaveau). OECD DAC Working Party on Development Finance Statistics, 2025. Consultancy.
2. Stocktake and Revised Methodology on the Peer Reviews on Development Finance Statistics (with Guillaume Delalande, Valérie Gaveau, and Yasmin Ahmad). OECD DAC Working Party on Development Finance Statistics, 2024.
1. Report on the ODA-Eligibility of Private Sector Instruments Extended in Developing Countries (with Tomáš Hos and Valérie Gaveau). OECD Development Assistance Committee, 2024.

INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCES

2026: SVPW-ASSP (Zurich); PEIO (IE); ISA (Columbus); MPSA (Chicago); EPSS (Belfast); APSA (Boston).

2025: PEIO (Harvard); IPES (UCLA).

WORKSHOPS AND EXTERNAL PRESENTATIONS

2026: Development Banking Research Conference (French Development Agency); Workshop on Infrastructures in International Relations (University of Hong Kong); International Conference on IOs and Global Governance at UIBE (Beijing); Shanghai Institutes for International Studies; Workshop on Development Finance and Global Economic Governance (NYU Shanghai); Aix-Marseille University; KfW Development Bank (Frankfurt); Biennial Workshop on International Financial Institutions (Villanova); OECD Annual Development Finance Data Forum (invited).

2025: The GODAD Workshop (Göttingen); Workshop on Mutual Interests in ODA (Kiel Institute); The Future of Development Assistance Workshop (invited, declined) (Pittsburgh); Political Economy of Aid and International Organizations Workshop (Milan-Bicocca); Reimagining Development Assistance Workshop (Pittsburgh).

2024: European Union's Global Gateway Workshop I (Princeton); European Union's Global Gateway Workshop II (TUM).

TEACHING

Instructor-of-record

Political Economy of Foreign Aid (UG, average evaluation: 3.8/4)	<i>Fall 2022, 2023; Spring 2025</i>
International Development Organizations (UG, not assessed)	<i>Spring 2023, 2024</i>
Bachelor Thesis Seminar (UG, average evaluation: 4/4)	<i>AY 2022, 2023, 2026</i>

Guest lectures at graduate level

Sciences Po's School of Public Affairs, invited by Prof. Matthias Thiemann	<i>Fall 2024</i>
EHESS Paris, invited by Prof. Liora Israël	<i>Spring 2020</i>

SUPERVISION

Supervision of 26 BA theses in International Relations	<i>2022-24</i>
Recipient of the Prize for Best Undergraduate Thesis in Political Science: Vera Rüegg (2024), Mariana Hervigo (nominee, 2023)	

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Discipline

Panel Co-Organizer: Firm-Level Preferences in Climate and Development Finance (APSA 2026)
Panel Chair: ISA 2026
Section Co-Chair, International Affairs Section, Swiss Political Science Association
Reviewer for <i>Comparative Political Studies</i> , <i>International Studies Quarterly</i> , <i>Revue internationale des études du développement</i>

Department

Co-Organizer, Master-Class on Process-Tracing Within Multi-Methods Design, Geneva	<i>2024</i>
Member, Search Committee for a Lecturer in International Relations, University of Geneva	<i>2023</i>
Member, Gender Equality Commission of the Global Studies Institute, University of Geneva	<i>2023-24</i>
Co-Convenor, Graduate and Post-Doctoral Research Seminar in Politics, University of Geneva	<i>2022-25</i>

Mentoring

Mentor, Graduate Applications International Network (GAIN)	<i>2025-26</i>
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GRANTS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Travel Grant, APSA International Collaboration Section (USD 500)	<i>2026</i>
Travel Grant, Academic Society of Geneva (CHF 1,900)	<i>2026</i>
Doctoral Mobility Scholarship, Swiss National Science Foundation (CHF 19,480)	<i>2025</i>
Faculty of Social Sciences Grant, University of Geneva (CHF 2,550)	<i>2025</i>
Research Grant, Ernst and Lucie Schmidheiny Foundation (CHF 6,500)	<i>2024</i>
Dissertation Grant, Swiss National Science Foundation	<i>2024</i>
Department Travel Grants, University of Geneva (CHF 2,000)	<i>2024, 2025</i>
Travel Grants, Geneva Global Studies Institute (CHF 2,000)	<i>2022, 2023, 2024</i>
Travel Grant, MethodsNET (EUR 1,600)	<i>2023</i>
Full Scholarship, Sciences Po	<i>2020-22</i>

AFFILIATIONS

Princeton Sovereign Finance Lab, Graduate Affiliate

Since 2024

Geneva Africa Lab, Graduate Affiliate

Since 2023

SKILLS

Software: R, Microsoft Office, L^AT_EX, CapitalIQ, Orbis, Refinitiv.

Languages: French (native), English (advanced), Spanish (intermediate).

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis, United Kingdom

2025

Mathematics for Social Sciences; Advanced Methods for Time Series and Panel Data

MethodsNET, Warsaw, Poland

2023

Workshop on Generalized Linear Models

OTHER RELEVANT PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Kiel Institute for the World Economy

Berlin, Germany

International Development Research Center

Consultant on a Gates Foundation-funded project on Mutual Interests in ODA

Apr – Jul 2025

OECD

Paris, France

Development Co-operation Directorate, Financing for Sustainable Development Division

Consultant

Nov 2024 – Mar 2025

PhD Trainee

Apr – Oct 2024

Sciences Po

Paris, France

Center for European Studies and Comparative Politics

Full time research assistant for Prof. Philippe Bezès

Jul – Aug 2021

Ecole normale supérieure – PSL

Paris, France

Maurice Halbwachs Center

Full time research assistant for Prof. Liora Israël

Jan – Mar 2020

French National Assembly

Paris, France

Commission for Sustainable Development and Territorial Planning

Summer Parliamentary Intern

Jun – Jul 2018